

describes is strong. In a 1970s' survey of college students, when asked whether they would continue working if they were to inherit enough money to live comfortably without a salary, seven out of ten said yes, they would still work. *Redbook* magazine, in a national survey of women aged 18 to 35, found that 80 percent said they would continue to work even if money were no problem. State lottery winners prove the point. In many cases after becoming rich, the winners take a short vacation and then go back to work.

CHANGING ATTITUDES

If you're a candidate for retirement at age 24, like J. Paul Getty, or at age 35, like me, you need to modify your work ethic. The work ethic helped build America. We're proud of the work ethic in our heritage. But retiring at age 35 with the work ethic intact is like an alcoholic's entering a rehabilitation center with a suitcase full of Chivas Regal.

The *Oxford American Dictionary* defines the work ethic as "a belief in the moral and sociological importance of work." But that same dictionary gives eight definitions of "work." We most often think of the fifth definition: "what a person does to earn a living; employment." But the dictionary's first definition is "use of bodily or mental power in order to do or make something." When you retire at age 35 you begin thinking of this broader first definition. Work is what you do with your life, what you accomplish over time. A work ethic that keeps you anchored to an office, filling out forms, making schedules, and reading reports is too narrow. Helping a friend, reading a poem, or learning how to cook are all part of "work" as well.

When you modify the old work ethic you should also get rid of the guilt that goes with it. Any number of self-help books tell you how to do this. They have names like *I'm Okay, You're Okay*, *Reality Therapy*, and *Your Erroneous Zones*. Books help you be your own best friend, help you be number one, and help you say no when you want to say no.